THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH NEWSLETTER

21 Sept 2009

Contents:

1 - October Visit to the Northern Ardennes, Remagen Bridge, The Rhine

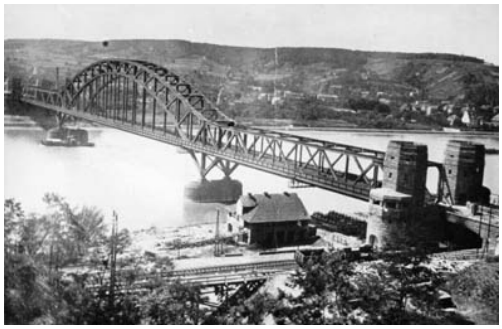
2 - Invitation de l'ANAP

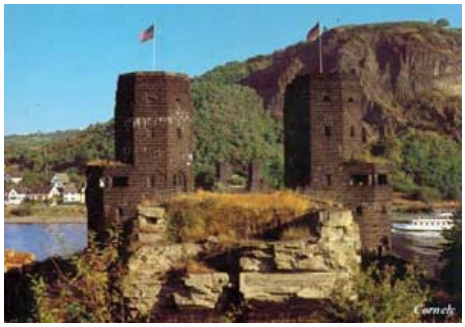
3 - Invitation to pay your subscription… Eng/fr

4 - Subscription form

THE BEGINNING OF THE END

The latest in the series of battlefield visits led by Colonel Oliver Warman (Balliol; late Welsh Guards) will take us to the northern Ardennes, and to the site of the allied crossing of the Rhine at Remagen Bridge. Oliver gives us as the theme of this visit « The Beginning of the End ». Interestingly, for those fascinated by the Appeasement movement, Oliver also plans to take us also to Bad Godesburg in the footsteps of Neville Chamberlain, a site symbolic of a period which might be tagged the Beginning of the Beginning.





The Remagen Bridge
at various stages in its history

Our visit will take place on Friday 16th-Sunday 18th October. The party will leave the Gare du Nord at 8.25 a.m. on the Friday, arriving at Köln at 12.15 p.m. The party will be met by a private transfer bus to our hotel in the centre of the Old Town, the Maritim Hotel. At 2 p.m. our Coach leaves the hotel for the first part of the tour, returning that evening. Then the Saturday part of the tour will be an all-day affair, finishing with a Rhine Steamer cruise in the late afternoon, hopefully before Götterdämmerung sets in.



The party return to Paris by the 3.44 p.m. train on Sunday 18th October, arriving at the Gare du Nord at 7.35 p.m.

The cost of the visit breaks down as follows:

- Return train journey, in Thalys 2nd Class, at today's group price of 130 euros per seat (later bookings by our facilitator would lead to a higher price).
- Hotel (2 nights), including breakfast, transfer bus to/from the station, air-conditioned coach for the tour, Rhine cruise and local taxes: Prices depend on the size of our party, ranging from 218 euros each for a group of 21-22, to 237 euros each for a group of 15-16 only. There would be a 50 euro supplement for a single room.

Although Oliver makes no charge to us for his services we must offer to contribute to his travel and hotel expenses, which should not exceed 50 euros per person, depending on how many we are. Apart from that the only important extras will be the cost of lunch and dinner on Friday and Saturday, and of lunch on Sunday..

If you wish to come on this tour please let Roger Thorn know as soon as possible on: roger.thorn@wanadoo.fr. As always guests are most welcome to join us. Provisional bookings have been made for the train and hotel, and further details will be released as soon as these bookings have been confirmed.

A.N.A.P.

RAVIVAGE DE LA FLAMME
Tuesday 29th September 2009

Our dear colleague Djamil Jacir, Président National of the Association Nationale des Anciens Parachutistes. (A.N.A.P),invites Branch members to attend the Ravivage de la Flamme sous l'Arc de Triomphe on Tuesday 29th September at 18h30. Those wishing to attend should be in place under the Arc by 18h15, as usual.

Branch members are then invited immediately after the ceremony to a Pôt d'Amitié, offered by A.N.A.P., at the

Cercle Mess de l'Ecole Militaire :
1, place Joffre,
75007 Paris.

Métro: Ecole Militaire.
Bus: 92 Etoile-Marceau mounting at the bus stop on avenue Marceau and alighting at Ecole Militaire).

---

3 Dear Member,

Time flies. A perfect excuse to write to you again: We are rapidly approaching the end of the Royal British Legion year and your subscriptions fall due at the end of September.

The exciting move to new premises with all sorts of new possibilities means you're your continued support is even more important for us for the coming year. It should be an interesting one.

The new HQ in Rue des Acacias are taking a little longer to renovate than forecast by the contractors (to everyone's amazement of course) but will be up and running shortly. The latest promise is for the 22 of September… (I like those three little dots the French seem too use more than the British to express a sort of undefined "Hmm") and this enables us to promise you an interesting and enriched social calendar for 2010.

The inaugural event will be for members, of course, to give you an opportunity to evaluate and to suggest ways to get the most from our new facilities. What would you like to see and do there? Your committee wants to know!

Other events will follow, open to everyone, especially potential new members. Do you have friends or relatives you would like to introduce to the RBL?

Once again your Committee would like to pay homage to those of you who continue faithfully to support the cause even though, because of health reasons, or because you live so far away, you are unable to participate actively in our events. The RBL's work is essentially charitable, your contributions are needed and your membership is the more appreciated for its disinterested nature. Even if we don't get to see you often, you are in our thoughts.

Anyway, to return to our muttons, may I ask you to make a special effort to send in your subscription before the end of October so that I can send out your membership cards in good time? You will be glad to note that it has not increased.

Should you lose the attached subscription form you can download another from the rblfrance.org website. You can also get a membership application form there should you find a potential member.

Don't forget to let me know if you have acquired or changed your e-mail address. during the year. The Paris Branch Newsletter can be consulted online. Many members now get it by e-mail. If you don't, and would like to, please let me know (by email) and I shall send you the link as and when new issues come out. If you prefer the paper and ink version – or if the online version is delayed for some reason - you will , of course, continue to receive it by post.

You can send any information to mfyates@gmail.com or to paris@rblfrance.org which is our official email address. Our website can be consulted at http://www.rblfrance.org/
Don't forget: you can also check events etc. on the site.

Subscription forms (with the new address) are included with this newsletter. I look forward to hearing from you all soon.

Best regards,

Mark Yates
Membership secretary

Que le temps passe vite ! Et j'ai déjà l'occasion parfaite de vous écrire encore une fois : L'année de la Royal British Legion s'est écoulée depuis ma dernière lettre et, puisque l'année RBL termine fin septembre, la date de renouvellement de votre abonnement est imminente.

Cette époque mouvementée, avec le déménagement vers la rue des Acacias, présente toute sorte de nouvelles possibilités et, plus que jamais, votre soutien nous est indispensable.

Les délais prévus par les entreprises concernées dans la rénovation des nouveaux locaux se sont avérés optimistes (quelle surprise !). Les travaux seront terminés le 22 septembre, disent-ils maintenant… Toutefois, ce sera certes pour très bientôt et c'est ainsi que nous pouvons vous promettre un calendrier d'évènements enrichi pour l'année à venir.

La célébration de notre aménagement sera réservée aux membres, et ceci sera l'occasion de nous faire parvenir vos idées, vos observations, quant à l'utilisation optimum de nos nouvelles capacités. Que voudriez-vous y faire ? Votre comité s'y intéresse !

S'ensuivront alors rapidement d'autres évènements ouverts à tous, plus spécialement à de nouveaux membres intéressés par les activités de notre association. Avez-vous déjà autour de vous des amis intéressés ? Peut-être serait-ce l'occasion de leur présenter le RBL .

Toutefois, certains parmi nos membres ne peuvent participer activement aux évènements que nous proposons à cause de problèmes de santé, ou parce qu'ils habitent très loin. Votre comité tient à rendre hommage à ceux-ci, qui restent fidèles pour la simple raison que nous sommes une association caritative vouée à une cause qui leur tient à cœur.

C'est pourquoi aujourd'hui, la rentrée étant enfin active, je vous invite à renouveler votre abonnement dès que possible. Les tarifs restant les mêmes que l'année dernière.

N'oubliez pas de me faire savoir si vous avez fait l'acquisition d'une adresse e-mail depuis l'année dernière – ou si vous avez modifié votre adresse. Actuellement un bon nombre de nos membres reçoivent notre « Newsletter » électroniquement et, si cette solution vous intéresse, vous n'avez qu'à me faire parvenir vos coordonnées. Bien sûr, si vous préférez la version sur papier, vous continuerez à la recevoir par la poste.

Pour tout renseignement, vous pouvez me contacter à mfyates@gmail.com ou à paris@rblfrance.org , cette dernière étant notre adresse officielle attachée à notre site web que vous pouvez consulter ici : http://www.rblfrance.org/

Vous trouverez ci-joint le formulaire d'adhésion (avec notre nouvelle adresse) à remplir et à renvoyer avec votre abonnement 2009-2010. A bientôt...

Bien cordialement

Mark Yates
Membership secretary

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION PARIS BRANCH

POPPY APPEAL ET COTISATIONS 2009/10
POPPY APPEAL & SUBSCRIPTIONS 2009/10

- Normal / *Normale* 46 Euros
- Reduced / *Réduite* (65 and + / *65 ans et* +) 37 Euros
- 25 years and under / *25 ans ou moins* 21 Euros

Poppy Appeal contribution

Don au "Poppy Appeal" .....

Annual subscription
Cotisation annuelle .....

Administrative Fund donation
Don aux fonds administratifs .....

TOTAL .....

Name / Nom .....

Address / Adresse .....

.....

e-mail ……..

Please tick the box below if you require a fiscal receipt and, if so, enclose a stamped addressed envelope.

Veuillez cocher la case si vous désirer un récépissé fiscal et, dans ce cas, joindre une enveloppe timbrée à votre attention.

☐

Please make your cheque payable to the "Royal British Legion".
Veuillez établir votre cheque à l'ordre de "Royal British Legion"

Royal British Legion. 28 rue des Acacias 75017 PARIS . Tel 01 47 42 19 26
Website : http://www.rblfrance.org/ e-mail : paris@rblfrance.org